

Binomial Theorem:

$$(a + b)^n = a^n + \binom{n}{1} a^{n-1}b + \binom{n}{2} a^{n-2}b^2 + \dots + \binom{n}{r} a^{n-r}b^r + \dots + b^n$$

General term:

$$\binom{n}{r} a^{n-r} b^r, 0 \leq r \leq n$$

Eg: Find the term independent of x in the expansion of $\left(2x + \frac{1}{x}\right)^{10}$

$$x^{10}, x^8, x^6, x^4, x^2, x^0$$

$$\binom{n}{5} a^{n-5} b^5 = \binom{10}{5} (2x)^{10-5} \left(\frac{1}{x}\right)^5 = 252 \times 32x^5 \times \frac{1}{x^5} = 8064$$

Arithmetic Progression:

Eg: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, ...

First term = 1

Common difference = 1

$$\text{nth term} = 1 + 1(n-1) = n$$

a = first term

d = common difference

$$u_n = \text{nth term} = a + d(n - 1)$$

In an arithmetic progression, the difference between successive terms is constant

Sum of first n terms:

$$S_n = \frac{1}{2}n(a + l) = \frac{1}{2}n\{2a + (n - 1)d\}$$

Geometric progression:

Eg: 1, 2, 4, 8, 16, ...

First term = 1

Common ratio = 2

nth term = $1 \times 2^{n-1} = 2^{n-1}$

a = first term

r = common ratio

u_n = nth term = ar^{n-1}

In a geometric progression, the ratio between successive terms is constant

Sum of first n terms:

$$S_n = \frac{a(1 - r^n)}{1 - r} \quad (r \neq 1)$$

A geometric progression converges when its common ratio is between -1 and 1

If a geometric progression converges, it has a sum to infinity

Eg: 16, 8, 4, 2, 1, 0.5, 0.25, ...

This progression will eventually converge as terms get smaller and smaller

$$S_\infty = \frac{a}{1 - r} \quad (|r| < 1)$$